2008 Honda Accord DX

$3,499 · 135,000 miles · Private seller · Rosamond, CA

Seller: Private seller

Source: Facebook Marketplace

Listing: https://www.facebook.com/marketplace/item/28956035447396963/

Report generated October 31, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder









+ 2 more photos in the app.

Out-the-door price	Monthly cost to own	Reliability
$4,000	**$404**	**Average**
Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare.	loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration	3/5 · 9 recalls · 1,521 NHTSA complaints

Budget — buying it

Vehicle price	$3,499.00
Use tax (9.25%) — paid at DMV	$323.66
Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price)	$22.74
Registration + CHP fee	$108.00
Transportation improvement fee	$32.00
Title transfer	$15.00
Total out-the-door	$4,000.40
+ Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop)	$150.00

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

Budget — paying for it

Down payment	$4,000.40
Amount financed	$0.00
Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection)	$4,150.40

Paid in full with your down payment — no loan needed.

Budget — owning it each month

Loan payment	$0.00
Insurance (estimate, liability)	$70.00
Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 25 MPG, $4.75/gal)	$190.00
Maintenance & repair reserve	$130.00
Registration renewal (÷12)	$14.40
Total per month	$404.40

Running costs without the loan: **$404/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$9,003** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

Insurance

Coverage	Typical Ridgecrest range	Estimate used
Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15)	$49–$112/mo	$70/mo
Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive)	$94–$243/mo	$135/mo

The budget above uses the **liability coverage** estimate ($70/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: common sedan/hatch. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

Reliability

Rating: Average (3/5)

8th-gen Accord with the 2.4L 4-cylinder and lower miles than most cars at this price. Solid in-town car; the 2008–2010 2.4L can burn oil.

NHTSA data for this model year: 9 recalls · 1,521 owner complaints (62 involving a crash). Most complaints: Service Brakes (574), Hydraulic (451), Air Bags (379), Engine (210), Exterior Lighting (113), Electrical System (105).

Known issues for this model

• 2008–2010 2.4L oil consumption (piston rings); check the oil level and ask how often it's topped up

• Rear brakes wear fast on this generation

• A/C compressor failures are common

• VTC actuator rattle on cold start

Check on this car before buying

• Get the VIN and check recalls (airbag inflator recalls were common on Hondas)

• Check the oil level and look for blue smoke

• Run the A/C for 15 minutes

• Listen for a rattle on a cold start

• Pre-purchase inspection

Notes

Added 2026-10-31 as an in-town ~$3k option. Listed 10/31. Clean title in hand, current tags, 135k mi, seller says it runs great with no issues. Rosamond is about 1.5 hours away via CA-14. Ask about oil use and the A/C, and get the VIN.

Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.